

Japan Packing Checklist

General traveler reference for KelanaAI RAG

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Purpose: A practical packing guide for travelers visiting Japan. Seasonal needs vary by region and month, and medicine/import rules can change. Travelers should verify current airline, Japan Customs, and Ministry of Health requirements before departure.

1. Essential travel documents

Item	Why to pack it
Passport	Carry your valid passport and keep a secure digital copy separately.
Visa / exemption notice	If your nationality requires a visa, carry the required evidence. Travelers using Japan's electronic visa or visa-exemption systems should follow the official display rules.
Flight details	Keep departure and return/onward travel information accessible.
Accommodation details	Save hotel addresses and booking confirmations.
Travel insurance	Keep policy number, emergency contact information, and coverage details.
Emergency contacts	Keep family/emergency contacts and relevant embassy or consulate details.

2. Clothing by season

Season	Suggested packing
Spring (Mar-May)	Light layers, long-sleeve tops, a light jacket, comfortable walking shoes, compact umbrella. Late spring can become warmer and wetter.
Summer (Jun-Aug)	Breathable clothing, sun protection, hat, refillable water bottle, small towel, compact umbrella. Japan's summer is often hot and very humid.
Autumn (Sep-Nov)	Light-to-medium layers, comfortable walking shoes, light jacket. Early autumn can remain warm; later autumn becomes cooler.
Winter (Dec-Feb)	Warm coat, thermal or layered clothing, gloves, scarf, warm socks. Hokkaido and mountain areas can be much colder and snowier than Tokyo/Osaka.

3. Medicine and health items

Japan allows travelers to bring certain medicines for personal use without an Import Confirmation when the quantity is within specified limits. Current Ministry of Health guidance states: **prescription drugs, poisons and deadly poisons: up to 1 month's supply; other drugs and quasi-drugs: up to 2 months' supply**; and certain external-use products may be brought within quantity limits. Some controlled or prohibited substances cannot be brought into Japan even for personal use.

If a medicine exceeds the permitted quantity or falls into a category requiring approval, travelers may need an **Import Confirmation** before departure. Keep medicines in original packaging when possible and carry supporting prescription or medical documentation for prescription medicines.

Important: Do not assume a medicine that is legal in another country is automatically legal in Japan. Check the Ministry of Health and Japan Customs rules for the specific active ingredient before travel.

4. Electronics and connectivity

Item	Planning note
Phone + charger	Save offline copies of key reservations and maps.
Power bank	Useful for long sightseeing days; follow your airline's current lithium-battery carry-on rules.

Item	Planning note
Plug adapter	Japan commonly uses Type A plugs; travelers from countries using other plug shapes may need an adapter.
Voltage check	Japan's electricity supply is 100 V. Check whether your device supports 100-240 V before using it.
Portable Wi-Fi / eSIM / SIM	Arrange data access if you need maps, translation, ticketing, or electronic travel notices.

5. Useful everyday items

- Comfortable walking shoes - many city itineraries involve substantial walking and train transfers.
- Small day bag - useful for passport, water, umbrella, charger, and purchases.
- Refillable water bottle - especially useful in hot weather.
- Compact umbrella - useful during rainy periods and sudden showers.
- Hand towel / handkerchief - useful because not every public restroom provides paper towels.
- Small amount of cash - cards and cashless payments are widespread, but some smaller businesses, temples, lockers, or rural locations may still prefer cash.
- Reusable shopping bag - convenient for daily purchases.

6. Region and trip-type adjustments

Tokyo / Osaka city trip: prioritize walking shoes, compact day bag, transit-friendly luggage, charger, and weather layers.

Hokkaido winter: add insulated outerwear, waterproof footwear, thermal layers, gloves, and traction-appropriate shoes.

Okinawa / summer beach trip: add swimwear, sun protection, light clothing, and hydration items.

Mountain / hiking trip: add appropriate footwear, rain protection, layers, and route-specific safety gear.

7. Before closing the suitcase

- Check the weather forecast for every destination, not only Tokyo.
- Check airline baggage and lithium-battery rules.
- Check Japan's latest medicine and customs rules for anything regulated.
- Keep passport, money, medicine, electronics, and essential documents in carry-on baggage where appropriate.
- Leave some luggage space for purchases.

8. Official sources

Japan National Tourism Organization (JNTO) - Weather & Geography
<https://www.japan.travel/en/plan/weather/>

Ministry of Health, Labour and Welfare - Bringing medicines for personal use into Japan
https://www.mhlw.go.jp/stf/seisakunitsuite/bunya/kenkou_iryuu/iyakuhin/kojinyunyu/topics/tp010401-1_00001.html

Japan Customs - Private importation of drugs, cosmetics, etc.
https://www.customs.go.jp/english/c-answer_e/imtsukan/1806_e.htm

Japan Customs - Goods with prohibitions, controls and restrictions
<https://www.customs.go.jp/english/summarv/prohibit.htm>

RAG note: This file uses explicit packing categories, season names, medicine limits, and traveler scenarios so KelanaAI can retrieve the correct passage from natural-language questions.